

Waheeda Rehman

There was something about the way Waheeda Rehman danced. It caught the eye of Guru Dutt, a trained dancer himself, and convinced him she could act. In *Pyaasa* (1957), he cast her as the young, waif-like prostitute in love with the poet. Waheeda is so compelling as Gulabo, begging Vijay's ex-lover to publish his work, tears streaming down her face in half-light when asked to define her relationship with him. But whether pathos, the part-reenactment of her own journey as a newcomer in the industry (*Kaagaz Ke Phool*, 1959), the joy of breaking free of shackles (*Guide*, 1965), or as the senile, sharp-tongued mother in *Namkeen* (1982), there was always dignity in her performances, an inherent poise—evident from when she was that 18-year-old debutante, until now, when at 84 she lent her grace to *Skater Girl* (Netflix, 2021).

Shabana Azmi

In *Masoom* (1983), you see two Shabanas—the regular mom, who talks of buying colouring pencils for her daughters, and the steely one who explodes at her husband's illegitimate son. That duality defines her. Shabana Azmi has always poured herself into characters like a shape-shifter. From her award-winning debut as the guilty wife (*Ankur*, 1974), to the petulant begum in *Shatranj Ke Khiladi* (1977), right up to her deliciously wicked witch in *Makdee* (2002), she knows how to effect a transformation in split seconds. Her roles speak for women—quietly rebellious partner (*Swami*, 1977), vulnerable wife (*Fire*, 1996), strong matriarch (*Godmother*, 1999).... What would Hindi cinema be without the blazing talent, fortitude and naturalistic verbal flair of Shabana Azmi? Difficult to even imagine.



INDIA PICTURE

TISS: CREATING LEADERS FOR SUSTAINABLE FUTURES

Q How do you locate the vision of TISS in the context of the call for higher education to respond to social realities?

Under the visionary leadership of Tatas, TISS was started in 1936 to train professional social workers in context the great depression where the urban centres like Bombay was facing serious health and livelihood crises impacting particularly the working class. Subsequently, be during the partition tragedy or in the aftermath of a series of disasters and humanitarian crises, our faculty members and students were actively engaged in mitigating the effects of such crises. After being integrated into the Higher Education ecosystem in the country as a fully funded Deemed to be University in 1964, the basic character of the Institute as a socially responsive institution continued to drive the academic programmes, research, field action and social policy contributions. This legacy continues even today.

Q Aligned with your Vision, what are the strides TISS is making in adopting NEP 2020?

The new NEP aligned FYUG programmes launched by TISS has (i) multidisciplinary learning (ii) strong field engagement, (iii) rigorous research project and (iv) multi-entry and multi-exit options. BSW (Tuljapur), Bachelor of Arts in Social Sciences (Guwahati and Tuljapur) and Bachelor of Science in Analytics and Sustainability Studies (Mumbai) are the NEP aligned UG programmes at TISS. New PG programmes include Cities and Governance, Global Mental Health, Animal Assisted Therapy, Disaster Informatics and Geospatial Technologies, two International dual degree programmes as well as a collaborative programme on International Electoral Management and Practices with Election Commission of India.

Q What do you think are theunique features of TISS Academic programmes?

TISS offers a pedagogical approach blended with strong theoretical foundations and practice orientations. Academia, society and industry linkages are the corner stones of all our academic programmes in several transdisciplinary areas. Students will be getting cutting edge training at TISS based on the principles of dignity, social justice and equity. All academic programmes, research and field action are linked to several of the SDGs thereby contributing to the global goals while strongly being rooted in local and regional contexts.



Prof. P. K. Shajahan
Dean, Academic Affairs